



Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

June 16, 2023

Sent Via Electronic Mail

Shad Springer, Director of Utilities
City of Santa Maria – Utilities Department
2065 E. Main Street
Santa Maria, CA 93454
Email: sspringer@cityofsantamaria.org

Dear Shad Springer:

**CITY OF SANTA MARIA WASTEWATER TREATMENT PLANT, 601 BLACK ROAD,
SANTA MARIA, CA 93458, SANTA BARBARA COUNTY:**

- **NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY FOR ENROLLMENT IN ORDER NO. R3-2020-0020, GENERAL WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS FOR DISCHARGES FROM DOMESTIC WASTEWATER SYSTEMS WITH FLOWS GREATER THAN 100,000 GALLONS PER DAY;**
- **TRANSMITTAL OF MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. R3-2023-0032; AND**
- **TERMINATION OF INDIVIDUAL PERMIT, WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER NO. R3-2010-0001 FOR THE CITY OF SANTA MARIA WASTEWATER FACILITY, SANTA BARBARA COUNTY.**

The Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Coast Water Board) reviewed the August 5, 2022, notice of intent and available documents associated with City of Santa Maria's domestic wastewater treatment facility (Wastewater System) located at 601 Black Road in Santa Maria, California. The Wastewater System, owned by the City of Santa Maria is currently regulated pursuant to *Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. R3-2010-0001 for the City of Santa Maria Wastewater Facility, Santa Barbara County* (Order No. R3-2010-0001).

On September 25, 2020, the Central Coast Water Board adopted *General Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. R3-2020-0020 for Discharges from Domestic Wastewater Systems with Flows Greater than 100,000 Gallons per Day* (General Permit).

This letter serves as a notice of applicability for enrollment in the General Permit. This letter includes: wastewater system operation summary, specific requirements, and

JANE GRAY, CHAIR | MATTHEW T. KEELING, EXECUTIVE OFFICER

limitations (Attachment 1); figures (Attachment 2); and City of Santa Maria's monitoring and reporting program requirements (Attachment 3).

This letter also serves as a notice of termination of City of Santa Maria's coverage in existing individual permit, Order No. R3-2010-0001.

City of Santa Maria must comply with the following:

1. **General Permit** – City of Santa Maria must comply with all conditions and requirements of the General Permit. As described in the General Permit, ongoing operation, maintenance, monitoring, and reporting are required. A copy of the General Permit can be found electronically at the following link:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/adopted_orders/2020/r32020_0020.pdf

2. **Monitoring and Reporting Program** – City of Santa Maria must comply with the requirements of the monitoring and reporting program enclosed with this letter (monitoring and reporting program no. R3-2023-0032, Attachment 3). City of Santa Maria must start implementing the monitoring on **October 1, 2023**. The first quarterly monitoring report is due **February 1, 2024** and the first annual report is due **March 1, 2024**. City of Santa Maria is also required to submit an annual pretreatment program report¹ due on March 1st and the annual volumetric reporting requirements² established by the State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board), due April 30th. Annual reports must be submitted to the GeoTracker database.

Quarterly monitoring reports and annual reports must be provided electronically in searchable PDF with the Central Coast Water Board's current transmittal sheet found at the link below as the cover page. The transmittal sheet must be signed.

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/water_issues/programs/wastewater_permitting/docs/transmittal_sheet.pdf

All annual reports must be formatted and completed as specified in the annual report template found at the following link:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/adopted_orders/2020/wdr_annual_report_format.pdf

City of Santa Maria must submit all reports/documents and laboratory data (using the transmittal sheet as the cover page) to the publicly accessible State Water

¹ California Code of Regulations title 23 section 2233 [View Document - California Code of Regulations \(westlaw.com\)](#)

² See: [Volumetric Annual Reporting | California State Water Resources Control Board](#)

Board's GeoTracker^{3,4} database with applicable Electronic Submittal of Information (ESI) requirements under the Wastewater System – specific global identification number **WDR100029526** over the internet at:

<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/esi/login.asp>

The attached monitoring and reporting program outlines the GeoTracker electronic reporting requirements. The Central Coast Water Board may request submittal of some documents on paper, particularly drawings or maps that require a large size to be readable, or in other electronic formats where evaluation of data is required.

3. **Fees** – City of Santa Maria paid an annual fee of \$123,934.00 on January 24, 2023 for coverage in existing individual permit, Order No. R3-2010-0001. This payment covers City of Santa Maria's enrollment in the General Permit for the 2022-2023 fiscal year.

City of Santa Maria must pay an annual fee to maintain coverage in the General Permit. Annual fees are determined by the State Water Board's fee program and cover the state fiscal year of July 1 through June 30. The Central Coast Water Board has lowered your assigned threat and complexity rating to 2A which will result in a reduced annual fee (currently \$41,063) starting with the 2023-2024 fiscal year. A copy of the current state fee schedule is available electronically at the following link:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wdr

4. **Notification** – The Central Coast Water Board will be notified of City of Santa Maria's enrollment at a regularly scheduled public meeting on August 24-25, 2023. Details about that meeting are available on our website at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_info/agendas/

5. **Future Discharge Modifications** – Pursuant to California Water Code section 13260, City of Santa Maria must inform the Central Coast Water Board at least 120 days prior to modifying your discharge. If there are any significant changes in either treatment or disposal methodologies, or the volume or character of the treated wastewater, City of Santa Maria must notify the Central Coast Water Board immediately of such changes.

³ Information for first-time GeoTracker users is available at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/ust/electronic_submittal/

⁴ Additional information available at: <http://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/>

Attachment 1 contains the Central Coast Water Board's understanding of the Wastewater System located at 601 Black Road, Santa Maria, CA 93458. Please review Attachment 1 to determine if the description is representative of your current system. Pursuant to California Water Code section 13267, City of Santa Maria must notify the Central Coast Water Board if this information is out of date or incorrect. You are required to provide staff with your updated information within **30 days** of issuance of this letter.

- 6. Responsible Party** – City of Santa Maria is responsible for the management and disposal of the domestic wastewater in compliance with the conditions of the General Permit. Any noncompliance with this General Permit constitutes a violation of the California Water Code, and subjects City of Santa Maria to enforcement action, and termination of enrollment under this General Permit.
- 7. Change in Ownership** - In the event of any change in control or ownership of the property, City of Santa Maria must notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this General Permit by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to the Central Coast Water Board so that the new owner or operator can be enrolled in the General Permit and City of Santa Maria's enrollment in the General Permit can be terminated.
- 8. Certified Operator** – City of Santa Maria is required to comply with the operator certification requirements⁵ administered by the State Water Board's Office of Operator Certification, which currently requires a Grade IV certified operator onsite to maintain and operate the Wastewater System. The City of Santa Maria must:
 - a. Keep a current Wastewater Treatment Plant Classification Form on file with the Office of Operator Certification and update the form when modifications to the Wastewater System treatment processes occur.
 - b. Provide the Office of Operator Certification with a Chief Plant Operator Acknowledgement Form and update this information within 30 days of a change of Chief Plant Operator.
 - c. If a contractor operator is used, the contract operator must register with the Office of Operator Certification and obtain a contract operator certificate for the Wastewater System.

Forms are available at the following link:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/water_issues/programs/operator_certification/form.html

⁵ Title 23 Division 3. Chapter 26 Wastewater Treatment Plant Classification, Operator Certification and Contract Operator Registration.

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/water_issues/programs/operator_certification/docs/ocr_clean.pdf

9. Termination of Permit – The existing individual permit, Order No. R3-2010-0001 is terminated, except for enforcement purposes.⁶ City of Santa Maria is responsible for compliance with Order No. R3-2010-0001 prior to the date of this letter.

10. Compliance Plan – As required in the attached monitoring and reporting program, City of Santa Maria must, by June 16, 2024, prepare and submit for Central Coast Water Board review and approval a time schedule compliance plan.

If you have any questions, please contact **Cecile Blancarte at (805) 542-4782 or by email at Cecile.Blancarte@waterboards.ca.gov** or Jennifer Epp at (805) 594-6181 or by email at Jennifer.Epp@waterboards.ca.gov.

Sincerely,

Jennifer Epp
Digitally signed by Jennifer Epp
Date: 2023.06.15 16:19:26
-07'00'
Water Boards

for Matthew T. Keeling
Executive Officer

Attachments:

Attachment 1: Wastewater System Operation Summary, Specific Requirements, and Limitations

Attachment 2: Figures

Attachment 3: Monitoring and Reporting Program Order No. R3-2023-0032

cc:

Alexandra Griffith, City of Santa Maria, agriffith@cityofsantamaria.org

Russ Newman, City of Santa Maria, rnewman@cityofsantamaria.org

Office of Operator Certification, wwopcertprogram@waterboards.ca.gov

Jennifer Epp, Central Coast Water Board, Jennifer.Epp@Waterboards.ca.gov

Jesse Woodard, Central Coast Water Board, Jesse.Woodard@waterboards.ca.gov

Cecile Blancarte, Central Coast Water Board, Cecile.Blancarte@Waterboards.ca.gov

WDR Program, GeoTracker RB3-WDR@Waterboards.ca.gov

⁶ The General Permit states "... where a Wastewater System discharge is currently regulated by an individual permit, that permit is terminated upon the enrollment of the Wastewater System into this General Permit."

ECM/CIWQS = CW-255678

GeoTracker No. = GT- WDR100029526

Rev 12/21/2022

ECM Subject Name = City of Santa Maria Wastewater Treatment Plant NOA for R3-2020-0020

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**ATTACHMENT 1
WASTEWATER SYSTEM OPERATION SUMMARY, SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS,
AND LIMITATIONS**

1. OWNERSHIP AND WASTEWATER SYSTEM INFORMATION

Ownership and wastewater system information submitted by City of Santa Maria to the Central Coast Water Board is shown in Table 1.

Table 1. Ownership and Wastewater System Information

Name	City of Santa Maria Wastewater Treatment Plant
Physical Address	601 Black Road Santa Maria, CA 93458
Latitude	34°56'54.93"N
Longitude	120°29'49.59"W
Mailing Address	2065 E. Main Street, Santa Maria, CA 93454
Owner	City of Santa Maria
Operator	Russ P. Newman phone: (805) 925-0951 x721 e-mail: rnewman@cityofsantamaria.org
Legally Responsible Official	Shad Springer phone: (805) 925-0951 x7211 e-mail: sspringer@cityofsantamaria.org
Raw Wastewater Characteristics	Sewer Connections: 22,020 Population Served: 107,407 Domestic (%): 91% Industrial (%): 9%
Permitted Design Flow, Average Monthly (Million gallons per day, mgd)	8.0
Baseline Flow (average annual flow) in mgd	7.2
Threat to Water Quality	2
Complexity	B
For Internal Use	
Fee Code	58
Primary Place Type	Wastewater Treatment Facility
Facility Type	Municipal/Domestic
Facility Waste Type	Domestic Wastewater
Regulatory measure Type	Enrollee - WDR
Reclamation Included	No
EPA Approved Pretreatment Program	Yes

2. WASTEWATER SYSTEM OPERATION SUMMARY

The City of Santa Maria wastewater treatment facility (Wastewater System) is a Class IV wastewater system. City of Santa Maria must staff a Grade IV chief plant operator for proper operation of the Wastewater System. The current chief plant operator is Russ P. Newman, Grade IV, Operator No. 29543, Certificate No. 28863 (expires 1/18/2026).

The Wastewater System is capable of treating 13.5 million gallons per day (mgd) to a secondary treatment level but is limited in disposal capacity to 8.0 mgd. The Wastewater System consists of the treatment technologies and treatment capabilities shown in Table 2.

Table 2. Treatment Technology and Capacity

Headworks/Preliminary Treatment	The headworks consists of a Parshall flume flow meter, three automatic bar screens followed by two aerated grit chambers.	
	Headworks capacity (mgd): 13.5	
Primary Treatment	Clarifiers: Primary treatment consists of two primary clarifiers that operate in parallel. The volume of each clarifying tank is 1.32 million gallons.	
	Primary treatment capacity (mgd): 27.92	
Secondary Treatment	Trickling Filters: Secondary treatment is performed using two primary and two secondary aerobic trickling filters. Each of the primary trickling filters has a volume of 543,000 gallons. Each of the secondary trickling filters has a volume of 170,000 gallons.	
	Secondary treatment capacity (mgd): 17.7	
Tertiary Treatment	Not Applicable	
	Tertiary treatment capacity (gpd): 0	
Disinfection	Not Applicable	
	Disinfection Capacity (gpd): 0	
Wastewater Disposal Method	Percolation Ponds, 123 acres	
	Disposal capacity (mgd): 8.0	
Biosolids/Sludge Production and Handling	Gravity Thickeners (2), Anaerobic Digestors (4), and Sludge Drying Beds, Offsite Composting, and Landfilling	
	Annual production of biosolids: 1,811 tons	
	The final destination of biosolids produced is hauled off to Engel and Gray Composting, Inc. located at 468-594 Ray Road, Santa Maria, California, and the City of Santa Maria Landfill, 2065 E. Main Street, Santa Maria, California	
Non-Potable Recycled Water	Non-potable recycled water produced onsite:	Not Applicable
	Recycled water usage areas:	Not Applicable

	Enrolled in WQ 2016-0068-DDW:	Not Applicable
	Recycled water production volume (gpd):	Not Applicable

A summary of historic and recent average effluent concentrations is included in Table 3, which were reported in City of Santa Maria quarterly monitoring reports. The Central Coast Water Board used reported effluent water quality data to establish the effluent and groundwater limitations in section 3.

Table 3. Effluent Water Quality for Select Constituents

Constituents	Unit ^{[1][2]}	Historical Average ^[3]	Annual Average for 2022 ^[4]
Carbonaceous Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day ^[5]	mg/L	43	45
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	39	37
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	844	1,055
Chloride	mg/L	156	143
Sodium	mg/L	145	140
Sulfate	mg/L	196	320
Boron	mg/L	0.35	0.41
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	43	42
Settleable Solids	ml/L ^[4]	<0.1	<0.1
pH	Standard Units	8	7.8

[1] mg/L denotes milligrams per liter.

[2] ml/L denotes milliliters per liter.

[3] Based on water quality data reported by City of Santa Maria in their 2018 to 2022 monitoring reports.

[4] Based on water quality data reported by City of Santa Maria in the 2022 Annual Monitoring Report.

[5] The City of Santa Maria has been reporting carbonaceous biochemical oxygen demand (CBOD) instead of biochemical oxygen demand (BOD). Monitoring and reporting program no. R3-2023-0032 requires the City of Santa Maria to report BOD.

3. WASTEWATER SYSTEM SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AND LIMITATIONS

City of Santa Maria must operate the Wastewater System in accordance with the General Permit and this notice of applicability. City of Santa Maria must comply with the wastewater specific limitations specified in Table 4 through Table 8.

Flow limitations are shown in Table 4. **Interim effluent limitations shown in Table 5 apply until June 16, 2025. After June 16, 2025, effluent limitations shown in Table 6 and Table 7 apply.**

A. Flow Limitations:

Table 4. Flow Limitations

Flow	Units	Limit	Point of Compliance
Maximum Daily Flow to Disposal Ponds	mgd	8.0	Influent IS-1

B. Effluent Limitations:

Based on reported water quality data, effluent water quality for Carbonaceous Biochemical Oxygen Demand and Total Suspended Solids (TSS) (see Table 3) exceed the General Permit effluent limits for a trickling filter treatment system. Therefore, pursuant to the General Permit, City of Santa Maria can comply with their individual permit No. R3-2010-0001 5-day Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD₅) and TSS limits for two years. **After June 16, 2025, trickling filter effluent limitations shown in Table 6 apply.**

Table 5. Interim Effluent Limitations: Trickling Filters (Until June 16, 2025)

Constituent	Units	30-Day Average	Daily Maximum
Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day	mg/L	60	100
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	60	100
Settleable Solids	mL/L	0.1	0.4
Total Dissolved Solids ¹	mg/L	1,000	Not Applicable
Sodium ¹	mg/L	180	Not Applicable
Chloride ¹	mg/L	180	Not Applicable
pH	Standard Units	Between 6.5 and 8.4	Between 6.5 and 8.4

[1] Compliance shall be based on a three-year running mean.

Table 6. Effluent Limitations^[1] (After June 16, 2025)

Constituent	Units	30-Day Average	7-Day Average	Sample Maximum
Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day	mg/L	30	45	Not Applicable
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	30	45	Not Applicable
Settleable Solids	mL/L	0.1	0.3	0.5
pH	Standard Units	Between 6.5 and 8.4	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

[1] The Central Coast Water Board understands that the City of Santa Maria will be upgrading the Wastewater System to comply with the new effluent limitations. Pursuant to General Permit Tables 3 through 5, the values in this table will vary depending on the treatment technology chosen. By June 16, 2024, the City of Santa Maria must report to the Central Coast Water Board the treatment technology chosen for the upgrades such that this notice of applicability can be updated as needed.

**Table 7. Effluent Limitations (After June 16, 2025)
Based on - Upper Guadalupe Groundwater Basin**

Constituents	Units	25-Month Rolling Median ^[1]
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	1,000
Chloride	mg/L	165
Sodium	mg/L	105
Sulfate	mg/L	500
Boron	mg/L	0.5

Constituents	Units	25-Month Rolling Median^[1]
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	10

[1] Rolling Median is the median from all data collected over the most recent 25 months.

C. Groundwater Limitations:

Based on review of historical effluent water quality (see Table 3), City of Santa Maria is currently unable to consistently comply with the General Permit effluent limitations for total nitrogen. The Central Coast Water Board understands that the City of Santa Maria will be designing upgrades to the Wastewater System to comply with the General Permit and will be providing a time schedule compliance plan as described in monitoring and reporting program no. R3-2023-0032. In the time schedule compliance plan, the City of Santa Maria must identify if it chooses General Permit section V.A.2 Option 1 or Option 2 for each constituent. Option 1 is to comply with the effluent limits in Table 7. Option 2 is to implement a groundwater monitoring program to demonstrate that the discharge does not cause underlying groundwater to exceed the water quality objectives set forth in the Basin Plan including the limitations listed in Table 8.

**Table 8. Groundwater Limitations
for Designated Groundwater Basin – Upper Guadalupe Groundwater Basin**

Constituents	Units	25-Month Rolling Median
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	1,000
Chloride	mg/L	165
Sodium	mg/L	230
Sulfate	mg/L	500
Boron	mg/L	0.5
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	1.4

ATTACHMENT 2 FIGURES

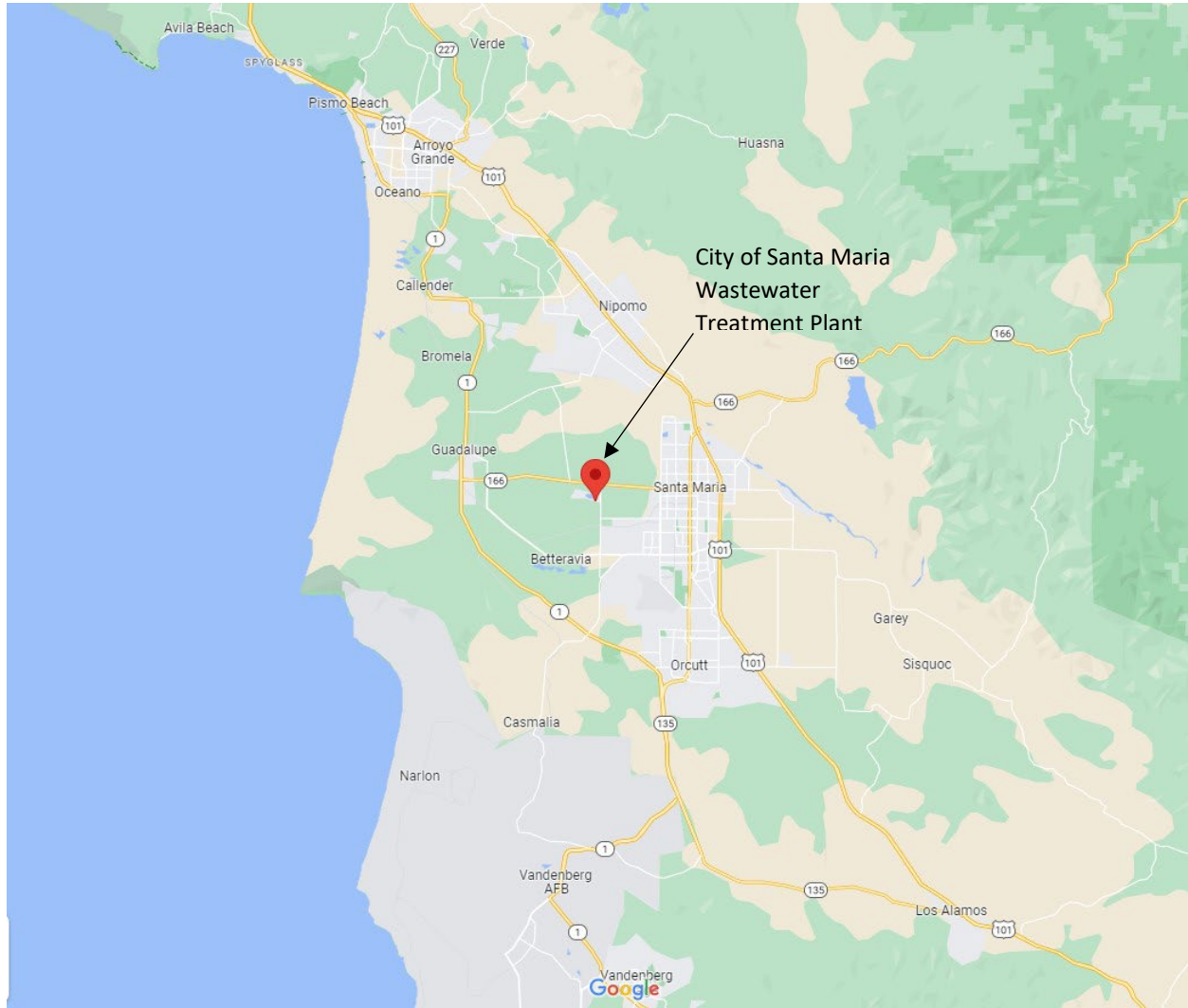


Figure 1 - Vicinity Map

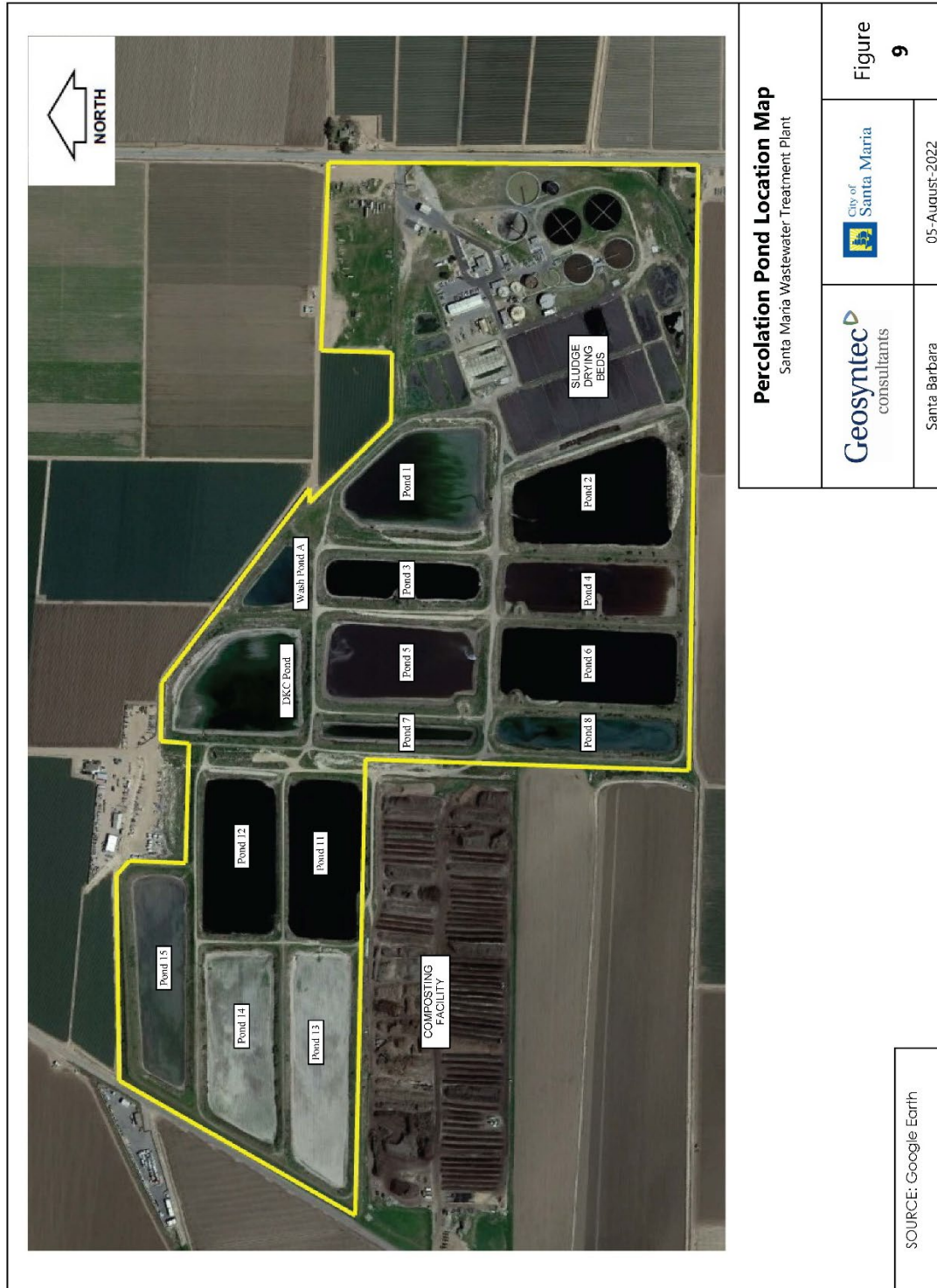
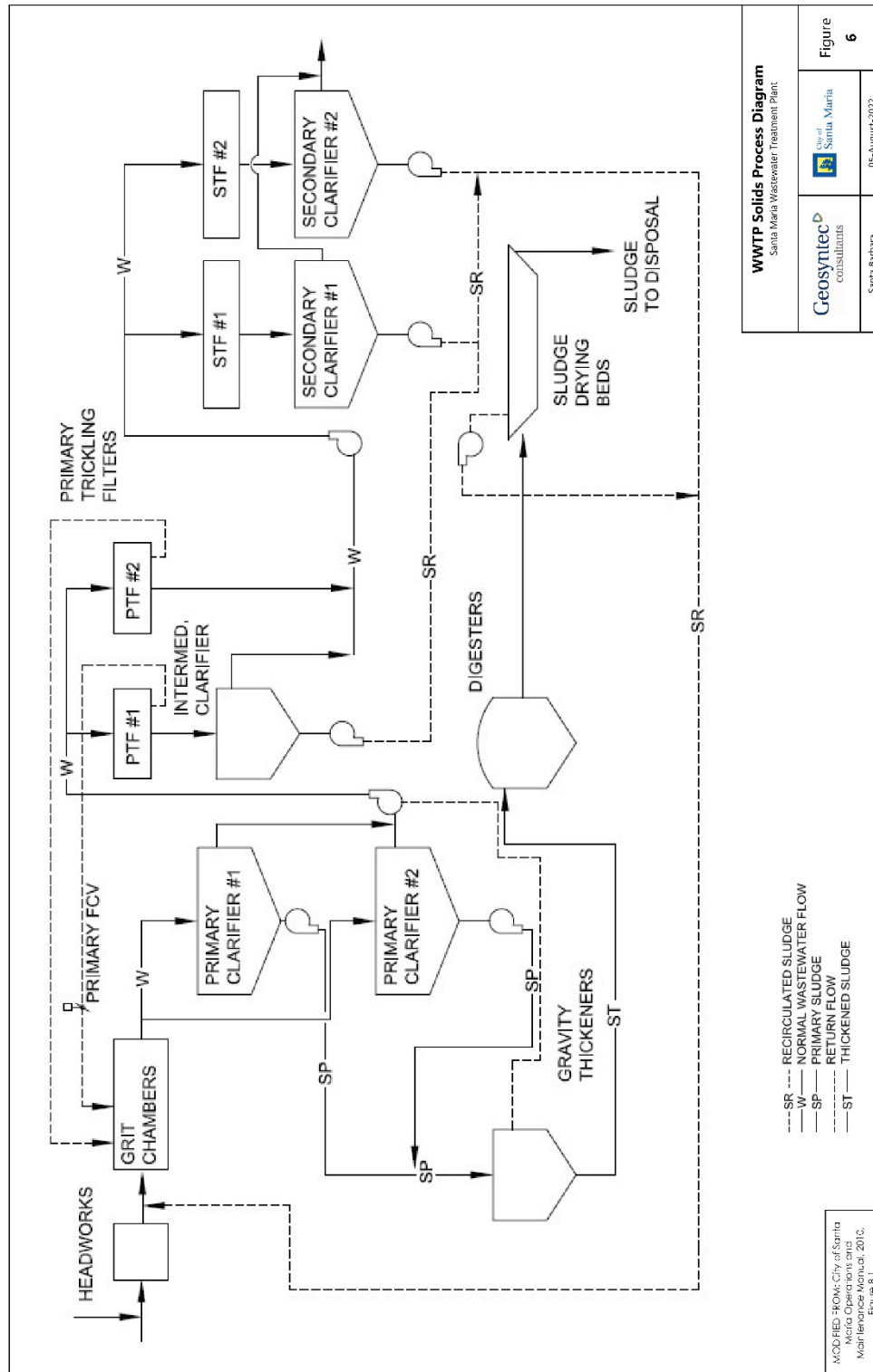


Figure 2- City of Santa Maria Wastewater Treatment Plant Site Map



WWTP Solids Process Diagram Santa Maria Wastewater Treatment Plant	
Geosyntec consultants Santa Barbara	City of Santa Maria 05-August-2022
Figure 6	

CENTRAL COAST REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. R3-2023-0032

June 16, 2023

MODIFICATION OF MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. R3-2020-0020

FOR

**CITY OF SANTA MARIA WASTEWATER TREATMENT PLANT
SANTA MARIA, SANTA BARBARA COUNTY**

This Monitoring and Reporting Program applies to the monitoring and reporting requirements for the City of Santa Maria Wastewater Treatment Plant (Wastewater System) enrolled in *General Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. R3-2020-0020 for Discharges from Domestic Wastewater Systems with Flows Greater than 100,000 Gallons per Day* (General Permit).

The City of Santa Maria owns and operates the Wastewater System that is subject to the General Permit and notice of applicability. The City of Santa Maria must not implement any changes to this monitoring and reporting program unless and until a revised monitoring and reporting program is issued by the Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Coast Water Board).

The State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board) and Regional Water Quality Control Boards are transitioning to the use of the publicly accessible State Water Board's GeoTracker database for the tracking of environmental and regulatory data for sites that operate under waste discharge requirements. The monitoring and reporting program directs the City of Santa Maria to submit reports (both technical and monitoring reports) and analytical data electronically to the State Water Board's GeoTracker database (see monitoring and reporting program section VI.C).

I. SAMPLING AND ANALYSIS

The City of Santa Maria must collect representative samples in accordance with the most recently approved sampling and analysis plan contained in the Operations and Maintenance Manual and validate analytical results prior to submittal to the Central Coast Water Board. All samples (e.g., wastewater, groundwater, soil, sludge) must be representative of the volume and nature of the discharge or matrix of materials sampled.

All samples must be collected by a qualified person, trained in proper procedures for collecting the samples. The name of the sampler, sample type (grab or composite), time, date, location, bottle/container type, and any preservative used for each sample must be recorded on the sample chain of custody form. The chain of custody form must also contain all custody information including date, time, and to whom samples were relinquished. If composite samples are collected, the basis for sampling (time or flow weighted) must be included in the sampling and analysis plan contained in the

Operations and Maintenance Manual for Central Coast Water Board review and approval.

- A. Sampling Schedule** – Unless otherwise specified below, sampling must be performed in accordance with Table 1.

Table 1. Sampling Schedule

Monitoring Period	Sample Collection Time
Quarterly	January, April, July, and October
Semiannual	April and October
Annual	October

Field test instruments (such as those used to evaluate pH, dissolved oxygen, and electrical conductivity) may be used if they are used by a State Water Board Environmental Laboratory Accreditation Program accredited laboratory, or:

1. The user is trained in proper use and maintenance of the instruments;
2. The instruments are field calibrated prior to monitoring events at the frequency recommended by the manufacturer;
3. Instruments are serviced and/or calibrated by the manufacturer at the recommended frequency; and
4. Field calibration reports are maintained and available for at least three years.

- B. Monitoring Location Descriptions** – All samples including influent samples (IS), effluent samples (ES), and groundwater monitoring wells (MW) must be collected at the locations described in Table 2. These locations must be consistent with the Central Coast Water Board approved sampling and analysis plan. **The City of Santa Maria must upload the GeoTracker field point information for each sampling location in the GeoTracker database once, prior to uploading laboratory data (see Table 10).**

Table 2. Sample Identification Details

GeoTracker Field Point Class	GeoTracker Field Point Name (Sample ID)	GeoTracker Field Point Description ^{[1][2]}
Influent Sample	IS-1	Raw wastewater sample collected at the headworks
Effluent Sample	ES-1	Treated wastewater sample collected downstream of the secondary clarifiers

GeoTracker Field Point Class	GeoTracker Field Point Name (Sample ID)	GeoTracker Field Point Description ^{[1][2]}
Effluent Sample	ES-A, ES-1a, ES-2 through ES-8, ES-11 through ES-15, and ES-DKC	Treated wastewater sample collected from the percolation ponds
Monitoring Well	MW-5H	Background Groundwater Monitoring Well Top of casing elevation unknown Perforations 160 to 602 ft bgs
Monitoring Well	MW-UMW1	Groundwater Monitoring Well Top of Casing Elevation 175.6 ft amsl Screened elevations unknown
Monitoring Well	MW-DMW1	Groundwater Monitoring Well Top of Casing Elevation 158.16 ft amsl Screened 87 to 135 ft bgs
Monitoring Well	MW-DMW2	Groundwater Monitoring Well Top of Casing Elevation 157.2 ft amsl Screened 82 to 155 ft bgs
Water Supply Well	WSW-1 ^[3]	Representative sample from potable well serving the city

[1] ft amsl denotes feet above mean sea level.

[2] ft bgs denotes feet below grade surface.

[3] Water supply sample data should be included in the annual report but does not need to be uploaded to GeoTracker if the Central Coast Water Board approves submittal of a Well Identification Number pursuant to the Water Supply Monitoring section below.

II. WATER SUPPLY MONITORING

Representative samples of the City of Santa Maria's raw water supply (sampled before use or treatment) must be collected and analyzed, at a minimum, for constituents specified in Table 3.

In lieu of the required water supply sampling, the City of Santa Maria may request Central Coast Water Board approval to submit a Well Identification Number and the reporting year's consumer confidence report (annual water quality report or drinking water quality report), as required by the State Water Board Division of Drinking Water and/or county, provided, at a minimum, all of the required constituents are sampled at the frequency specified in Table 3. The City of Santa Maria must report the results of any constituent monitored more frequently than is required by the monitoring program shown in Table 3. The City of Santa Maria must also report detectable concentrations (above the reporting limit) for any other constituent that has a published maximum contaminant level (MCL).

The City of Santa Maria must evaluate and provide a tabular summary of the water supply data with the annual monitoring report.

Table 3. Water Supply Monitoring

Constituent	Units^[1]	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Nitrate (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Chloride	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Sodium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Sulfate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Boron	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Carbonate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Bicarbonate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Calcium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Potassium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Magnesium	mg/L	Grab	Annually

[1] mg/L denotes milligrams per liter.

III. INFLUENT AND EFFLUENT MONITORING

A. Influent Flow Monitoring – The City of Santa Maria must monitor and report flow in million gallons per day, as described in Table 4, with each monitoring report. See monitoring and reporting program section VI.A.4 for supplemental volumetric annual reporting requirements established by the State Water Board.

Table 4. Influent Flow Monitoring

Parameter	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency	Sample Location
Daily Flow	Metered	Daily	IS-1
Maximum Daily Flow	Metered	Monthly	IS-1
Mean Daily Flow	Calculated	Monthly	IS-1
Percent of Permitted Flow ^[1]	Calculated	Quarterly	IS-1

- [1] The General Permit notice of applicability specifies the Wastewater System's maximum permitted flow. In the monitoring reports, the City of Santa Maria must evaluate and provide a comparison of monitored flow to the permitted flow.

B. Wastewater System Monitoring – Representative samples of The City of Santa Maria's influent (raw wastewater) into the Wastewater System and effluent (treated wastewater) discharged to percolation ponds must be collected and analyzed in accordance with the treatment technology-based monitoring requirements (including sample type and frequency) summarized in the tables below. See Figure 1 for the location of samples and GeoTracker field points.

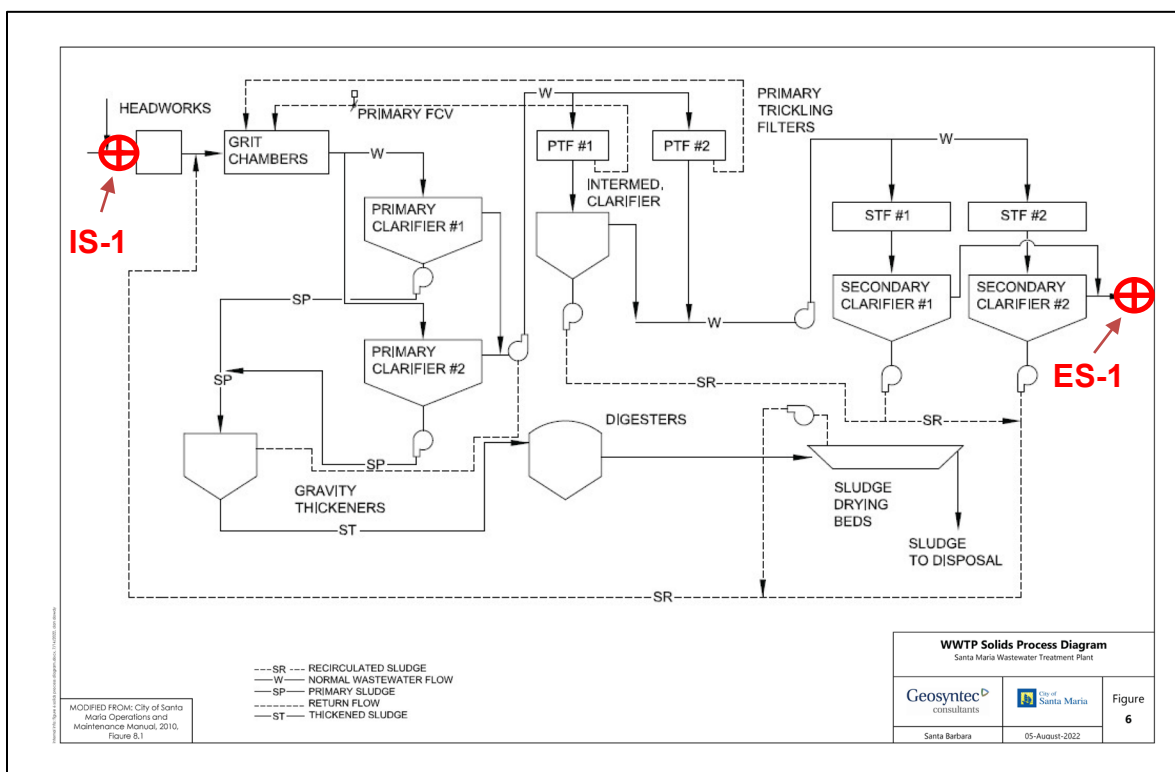


Figure 1. Process Flow Diagram and Sample Locations Referenced in Table 2

**City of Santa Maria Wastewater Treatment Plant:
Sampling Points and Monitoring Wells**

⊗ Monitoring Well
♦ Sampling Point

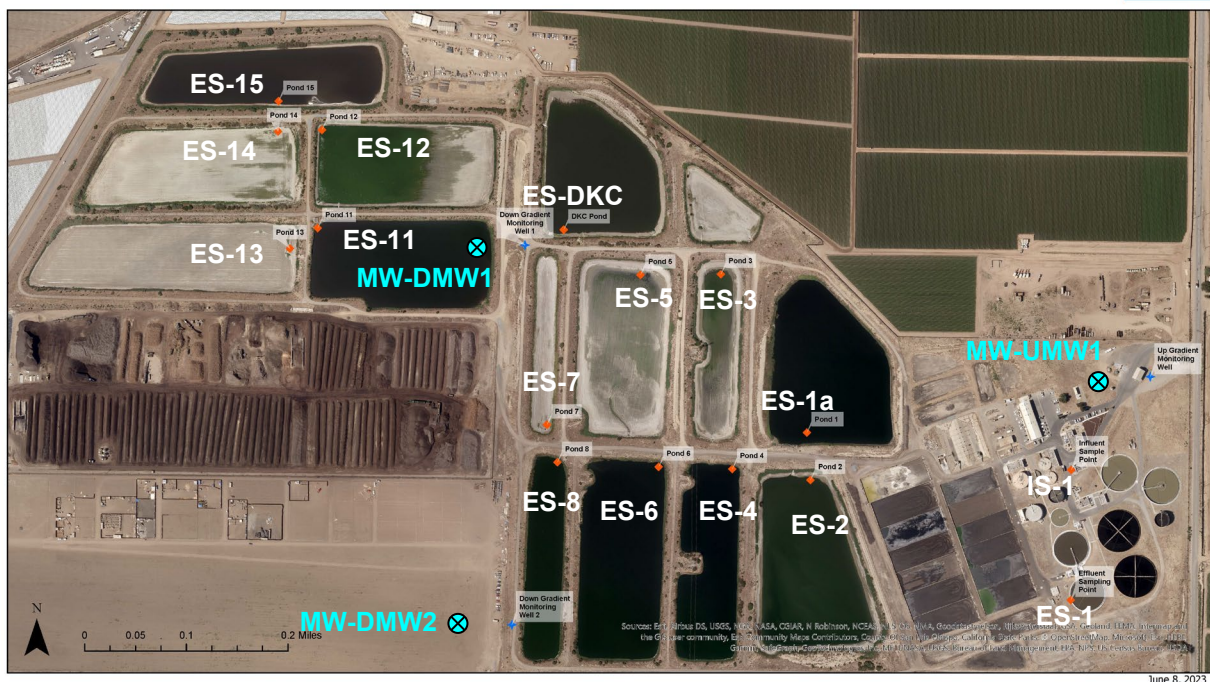


Figure 2. Percolation Pond and Groundwater Monitoring Well Sample Locations Referenced in Table 2



Figure 3. Water Supply and Groundwater Monitoring Well Sample Locations Referenced in Table 2

1. Pond System Monitoring

- i. **Required Pond Monitoring** – All wastewater treatment and treated wastewater storage/disposal ponds (lined and unlined) must be monitored as specified in Table 5. Sampling for dissolved oxygen must be a grab sample taken from 1 foot below pond surface¹.

Observations do not need to be reported in the monitoring reports unless a violation, significant change, or treatment issue is observed. Photos of the pond(s) verifying the observations must be collected annually and included in the annual report, with the date and location of the photo clearly marked. Observations must be noted in a logbook or database and made available to the Central Coast Water Board upon request. Any problems must be promptly corrected and recorded.

¹ Pond dissolved oxygen sample collection may be omitted if collection is deemed infeasible or unsafe to perform by the wastewater treatment plant chief plant operator.

Table 5. Wastewater Treatment/Storage/Disposal Pond Monitoring

Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling/Monitoring Frequency
Freeboard	0.1 feet	Measured	Weekly
Dissolved Oxygen (in pond) ^[4]	mg/L	Grab	Monthly
Sludge Depth ^[1]	0.1 feet	Measured	Annually
Color	Not applicable	Observation	Monthly
Vegetation in and surrounding ponds	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Berm condition	Not Applicable	Observation	Monthly
Precipitation	inches/day and date	Measured ^[2]	Each precipitation event ^[3]

[1] Sludge depth will not be required at disposal ponds if the disposal pond was dried and scarified within the reporting year. The annual report must provide dates of when the disposal ponds have been dried and scarified.

[2] The City of Santa Maria may use a rain gauge or use a National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, United States Geological Survey, or California Irrigation Management Information System weather station, such as <http://scacis.rcc-acis.org/>.

[3] A precipitation event is one producing precipitation of ½ inch or more.

[4] Pond sample collection may be omitted if collection is deemed infeasible or unsafe to perform by the wastewater treatment plant chief plant operator.

2. Trickling Filter System Monitoring

- i. **Influent and Effluent Monitoring** – At a minimum, influent and effluent constituent monitoring for the trickling filter system must be monitored as specified in Table 6.

Table 6. Influent and Effluent Monitoring for Trickling Filter Systems

		INFLUENT (IS-1)	INFLUENT (IS-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)
Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
pH	units	Grab	Weekly	Grab	Weekly
Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	24-hr composite	Monthly
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	24-hr composite	Monthly
Settleable Solids	ml/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Weekly

		INFLUENT (IS-1)	INFLUENT (IS-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)	EFFLUENT (ES-1)
Parameter/ Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Total Nitrogen ^[2]	mg/L	Calculated	Quarterly	Calculated	Monthly
Nitrate (as N) + Nitrite (as N)	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen (as N)	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Ammonia (as N)	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Chloride	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Sodium	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Sulfate	mg/L	24-hour composite	Quarterly	Grab	Monthly
Boron	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Monthly
Carbonate	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Semiannually
Bicarbonate	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Semiannually
Calcium	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Semiannually
Potassium	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Semiannually
Magnesium	mg/L	Not Required	Not Required	Grab	Semiannually

[1] Total nitrogen is the sum of total inorganic nitrogen (nitrate + nitrite + ammonium + ammonia) and organic nitrogen.

IV. SLUDGE/BIOSOLIDS DISPOSAL MONITORING

The City of Santa Maria must report the handling and disposal of all sludge/biosolids generated at the Wastewater System. Records must include the date removed from the Wastewater System, name/contact information for the hauling company, the type and volume of waste transported, the disposal facility name and address, and copies of analytical data required by the entity accepting the waste. These records must be submitted as part of the annual monitoring report.

The City of Santa Maria must also monitor sludge/biosolids consistent with a Central Coast Water Board approved sludge management plan and in accordance with the

requirements specified by the receiving party, including a regulated landfill and/or regulated composting facility.

If sludge/biosolids are not removed during the year, the City of Santa Maria must explain the absence of this monitoring in the annual report.

V. GROUNDWATER MONITORING

- A.** General Permit section V.A.2 provides two choices for compliance, effluent limitations, or groundwater monitoring.

In the time schedule compliance plan, the City of Santa Maria must identify if it chooses General Permit section V.A.2 Option 1 or Option 2 for each constituent. Option 1 is to comply with the effluent limits (refer to notice of applicability Table 7). Option 2 is to implement a groundwater monitoring program to demonstrate that the discharge does not cause underlying groundwater to exceed the water quality objectives set forth in the Basin Plan (refer to notice of applicability Table 8).

Existing upgradient and downgradient groundwater monitoring wells are located within the percolated effluent mound at the Wastewater System. The current monitoring well network is not adequate for the assessment of upgradient background water quality and/or downgradient water quality trend for the City of Santa Maria Wastewater System (Fugro 2007)².

By June 16, 2024, (with the time schedule compliance plan) the City of Santa Maria must notify the Central Coast Water Board of the city's choice for compliance for each constituent pursuant to General Permit section V.A.2 Option 1 or Option 2 (complying with an effluent limit or demonstrating compliance through a groundwater monitoring program).

If the City of Santa Maria chooses Option 2 for any constituent, by **October 16, 2024**, the City of Santa Maria must:

1. Submit a groundwater monitoring workplan and preliminary hydrogeologic conceptual site model for Central Coast Water Board approval. At a minimum, the workplan must propose the installation of three shallow groundwater monitoring wells to establish groundwater gradient, groundwater flow velocity and direction, and evaluate downgradient groundwater quality influenced by the wastewater disposal. The number and location of the proposed groundwater monitoring well network must be on a scale sufficient to determine potential impacts and be sufficiently representative of groundwater conditions upgradient and downgradient of the permitted disposal/dispersal area. The groundwater

² Hydrogeologic and Water Quality Review of Groundwater Conditions for the Wastewater Treatment Plant, Santa Maria, California. Fugro West, Inc. September 2007

monitoring wells should not be installed prior to Central Coast Water Board approval of the groundwater monitoring workplan and preliminary hydrogeologic conceptual site model.

The groundwater monitoring wells must be installed within first encountered groundwater and in accordance with California Department of Water Resources Bulletin No. 74-81 and Supplement No. 74-90, California Water Code sections 13710 through 13755, and any local permitting requirements. The locations and top-of-casing elevations for the newly installed monitoring wells must be surveyed by a licensed land surveyor. The City of Santa Maria must install³ the Central Coast Water Board approved groundwater monitoring well network within **90 days** of receiving Central Coast Water Board approval.

2. Once installed, all monitoring wells designated as part of the monitoring well network must be, at a minimum, sampled and analyzed as specified in Table 7 and the Central Coast Water Board approved sampling and analysis plan (see section VI.A.2.i of the General Permit).

Prior to sampling, depth to groundwater must be measured and groundwater elevations⁴ must be calculated. The monitoring wells must be purged of at least three well volumes and until measurements of the following parameters have stabilized (i.e., are reproducible within 10 percent): pH, temperature, dissolved oxygen, electrical conductivity, and turbidity. No-purge, low-flow, or other sampling techniques are acceptable only if they are approved in advance by the Central Coast Water Board and described in an approved sampling and analysis plan. Once the groundwater level in each of the wells has recovered sufficiently to ensure the collection of representative groundwater samples, a qualified individual (e.g., consultant, technician) trained in using proper sampling methods must recover samples using approved USEPA methods. Laboratories analyzing groundwater samples must be accredited by the State Water Board Environmental Laboratory Accreditation Program, in accordance with California Water Code section 13176, and must include quality assurance/quality control data with their reports.

The City of Santa Maria must provide monitoring well field sheets and report monitoring data, as described in Table 7, with each monitoring report.

3. Groundwater monitoring must include and must be consistent with Table 7 if Option 2 is chosen. Some constituents in Table 7 may be removed by the Central

³ Well installation must be supervised by a California licensed Civil Engineer or Professional Geologist.

⁴ The locations and top-of-casing elevations for the existing groundwater monitoring wells must be surveyed by a licensed land surveyor if not already completed at the time of installation.

Coast Water Board if compliance for that constituent is chosen by the City of Santa Maria to be an effluent limitation.

Table 7. Groundwater Monitoring if Option 2 is Chosen

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Groundwater Elevation ^[1]	0.01 ft amsl	Calculated	Quarterly
Depth to Groundwater ^[1]	0.01 ft bgs	Measurement	Quarterly
Gradient	feet/feet	Calculated	Quarterly
Groundwater Flow Direction ^[2]	degrees	Calculated	Quarterly
Total Nitrogen ^[3]	mg/L	Calculated	Quarterly
Nitrate (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Nitrite (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Ammonia (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Chloride	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Sodium	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Sulfate	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Boron	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Carbonate	mg/L	Grab	Semiannually
Bicarbonate	mg/L	Grab	Semiannually
Calcium	mg/L	Grab	Semiannually
Potassium	mg/L	Grab	Semiannually
Magnesium	mg/L	Grab	Semiannually
pH	pH Units	Metered	Quarterly
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/L	Metered	Quarterly
Phenol ^[4]	mg/L	Grab	Annual
Formaldehyde ^[4]	mg/L	Grab	Annual

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Zinc ^[4]	mg/L	Grab	Annual

- [1] ft amsl denotes feet above mean sea level and ft bgs denotes feet below ground surface.
 [2] Calculations must be prepared by, or under the responsible charge of, a California licensed professional.
 [3] Total nitrogen is the sum of total inorganic nitrogen (nitrate + nitrite + ammonium + ammonia) and organic nitrogen.
 [4] Sampling required once every five years if not detected in initial sample.

4. Groundwater monitoring reports, workplans, and other technical reports that interpret groundwater data must be prepared and stamped by a California licensed civil engineer or professional geologist.

B. GROUNDWATER MONITORING PRIOR TO OCTOBER 16, 2024

Table 8. Groundwater Monitoring Prior to October 16, 2024

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Groundwater Elevation	0.01 ft amsl	Calculated	Quarterly
Depth to Groundwater	0.01 ft bgs	Measurement	Quarterly
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	Calculated	Quarterly
Nitrate (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Nitrite (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Ammonia (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Chloride	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Sodium	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Sulfate	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly
Boron	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly

VI. REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

A. QUARTERLY AND ANNUAL MONITORING REPORTS

Quarterly and annual monitoring reports are due as described in Table 9.

Table 9. Quarterly and Annual Monitoring Reporting

Report	Monitoring Period	Report Due Date
First Quarter Monitoring Report	January 1 to March 31	May 1
Second Quarter Monitoring Report	April 1 to June 30	August 1
Third Quarter Monitoring Report	July 1 to September 30	November 1
Fourth Quarter Monitoring Report	October 1 to December 31	February 1
Annual Monitoring Report	January 1 to December 31	March 1
Annual Pretreatment Program Report	January 1 to December 31	March 1
State Water Board Volumetric Annual Reporting	January 1 to December 31	April 30

1. **Quarterly Monitoring Reporting** – At a minimum, the quarterly reports must include:
 - i. Results of all required monitoring in tabular format.
 - ii. The results of any pollutant or parameter monitored more frequently than is required by this monitoring program. Values obtained through additional monitoring must be used in calculations as appropriate.
 - iii. A comparison of monitoring data to the discharge specifications, applicable effluent limitations, disclosure of any violations of the notice of applicability and/or General Permit, and an explanation of any violation of those requirements. **The City of Santa Maria must calculate 7-day averages, 30-day averages and 25-month rolling medians for select analytes when comparing monitoring data to applicable effluent limitations specified in the General Permit.** Data must be presented in tabular format.
 - iv. Copies of laboratory analytical report(s) and chain of custody form(s).
 - v. An updated hydrogeologic conceptual site model with the groundwater monitoring reporting requirements based on new information generated from the monitoring well boring logs, groundwater elevation data, and water quality data.
 - vi. Copies of groundwater monitoring well field sheets with purge methods and data.

2. **Annual Monitoring Reporting** – The City of Santa Maria must submit annual reports in compliance with Standard Provisions 2013⁵, (and any updates to the Standard Provisions) Section C, General Reporting Requirements, Item 16 using the most recent annual report template provided by Central Coast Water Board.

The current annual report template can be found here:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/adopted_orders/2020/wdr_annual_report_format.pdf

3. **Annual Pretreatment Program Report** – Pursuant to California Code of Regulations, title 23, section 2233, subdivision (a), because the City of Santa Maria's Wastewater System is designed to treat over five million gallons a day, the city must have and enforce an adequate pretreatment program approved by the Central Coast Water Board. The City of Santa Maria's Pretreatment Program was approved by the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) in 1982. The Pretreatment Program monitors compliance of permitted facilities and attempts to identify and reduce pollutants to both sanitary and stormwater collection systems. On occasion, there may be a need to modify an existing pretreatment program, as identified by either the City of Santa Maria or the Central Coast Water Board. These modifications may be driven by a variety of factors such as, but not limited to, a change in conditions at the Wastewater System, a recalculation of local limits (or reallocation of the maximum allowable industrial loading), changes to federal pretreatment regulations, or a change in the industrial user base discharging to the Wastewater System. Substantial modification is defined in title 40 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) 403.18(b).

For substantial modifications, the City of Santa Maria must submit in writing to the Central Coast Water Board the rationale for the substantial modification, a detailed description of the proposed modification, and other documents considered necessary by Central Coast Water Board staff.

The City of Santa Maria must submit an annual Pretreatment Program report in accordance with title 40 CFR 403.12(i) that describes the City of Santa Maria's pretreatment program activities, including activities of all participating agencies, if more than one jurisdiction is involved in the program. The report must include, at a minimum, the applicable required data in appendix A to 40 CFR part 127 which requires the following data to be added or updated annually:

- i. Pretreatment program approval or modification date

⁵ See General Permit Attachment E, Standard Provisions, 2013:
https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/docs/wdr_standard_provisions_2013.pdf

- ii. Pretreatment program modification type
- iii. Industrial user type
- iv. Significant industrial user subject to local limits
- v. Significant industrial user subject to local limits more stringent than categorical standards
- vi. Significant industrial user wastewater flow rate
- vii. Industrial user causing problems at the Wastewater System
- viii. Receiving resource conservation and recovery act (RCRA) waste
- ix. Receiving remediation waste

The report must also include a summary of changes to the City of Santa Maria's pretreatment program that have not been previously reported to the Central Coast Water Board and any other relevant information requested by the Central Coast Water Board.

4. **State Water Board Volumetric Annual Reporting** – The City of Santa Maria must electronically certify and submit a summary of the monthly influent and effluent flow volume by April 30th of each calendar year via the State Water Board's Internet GeoTracker database.⁶

The following information is required:

- i. Monthly volume of wastewater collected and treated by the wastewater treatment plant (i.e., total monthly influent volume).
- ii. Monthly volume of wastewater treated, specifying level of treatment, including treated wastewater discharged.
- iii. If applicable, monthly volume of recycled water distributed, and annual volume of treated wastewater distributed for beneficial use in compliance with California Code of Regulations, title 22 use categories.

Additional information about volumetric annual reporting of wastewater and recycled water and the Recycled Water Policy is available at the Recycled Water Policy Volumetric Annual Reporting Website⁷.

⁶ See: <https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/>

⁷ See: [Volumetric Annual Reporting | California State Water Resources Control Board](#)

B. NON-COMPLIANCE REPORTING:

The City of Santa Maria must notify and report to Central Coast Water Board noncompliance of limits related to pond freeboard, flow rate, bypass or overflow, and wastewater containment failure, pursuant to General Permit section VI.C.2.

C. ELECTRONIC GEOTRACKER SUBMITTAL

All monitoring reports must be provided electronically in a searchable PDF format, with the Central Coast Water Board's current transmittal sheet found at the link below as the cover page. The transmittal sheet must be signed.

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/water_issues/programs/wastewater_permiiting/docs/transmittal_sheet.pdf

The City of Santa Maria must submit all reports/documents and laboratory analytical data to the State Water Board's GeoTracker^{8,9} database consistent with applicable Electronic Submittal of Information (ESI) requirements under the Wastewater System-specific global identification number **WDR100029526** at:

<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/esi/login>

For general questions, please contact the GeoTracker Help Desk at:

Geotracker@waterboards.ca.gov.

Table 10 summarizes all the GeoTracker electronic reporting requirements. Central Coast Water Board may request submittal of some documents on paper, particularly drawings or maps that require a large size to be readable, or in other electronic formats where evaluation of data is required.

Table 10. GeoTracker Electronic Submittal Information Data Requirements

Electronic Submittal	Description of Action	Action	Frequency
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⁸ Information for first-time GeoTracker users is available at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/ust/electronic_submittal/docs/beginnerguid2.pdf

⁹ Additional information available at:

<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/>

Electronic Submittal	Description of Action	Action	Frequency
Reports and Documents	Complete copy of all documents including monitoring reports (in searchable PDF format) and any other associated documents related to the Wastewater System.	Upload directly to GeoTracker all monitoring reports (in searchable PDF format) and any other associated documents.	On or before the due dates required by this General Permit and for other documents when required by the Central Coast Water Board.
Laboratory Data	All analytical data (including geochemical data) in electronic deliverable format (EDF). This includes all water, soil, and vapor samples collected when monitoring a discharge.	Upload, or direct your California ELAP-accredited laboratory staff to upload, all EDF laboratory data directly to GeoTracker.	On or before the due date of the required monitoring report.
Depth to Groundwater	Monitoring wells must have the depth-to-water information reported. Report data only for wells defined as permanent sampling points.	Upload depth-to-water information to the GeoTracker GEO_WELL file.	On or before the due date of the required monitoring report.
Boring Logs and Well Screen Intervals	Boring logs must be prepared by a registered professional and submitted in PDF format separately (not only as attachments to reports).	Upload boring logs (in searchable PDF format) to GeoTracker GEO_BORE file whenever a new boring is drilled.	Every time a new boring is drilled.
Field Points, Location Data (Geo XY) ^[1]	Name, classify, and identify the location (latitude and longitude) of all sampling points. Monitoring wells must be surveyed, influent and effluent sample locations must be identified on the GeoTracker mapping tool under "non-surveyed data." These data points are required prior to laboratory data uploads.	Upload the location data (surveyed and non-surveyed) to the GeoTracker Geo_XY file.	Every time a permanent monitoring point is established.

Electronic Submittal	Description of Action	Action	Frequency
Elevation Data (Geo Z) ^[2]	Survey and mark the elevation at the top of groundwater well casings for all permanent groundwater wells. These points are required prior to depth-to-water data uploads.	Upload the survey data to the GeoTracker GEO_Z file.	One-time, for all groundwater monitoring wells.
Geo Map	Site layout, map of facilities, Wastewater System including treatment and disposal area(s).	Upload the Site layout PDF to the GeoTracker site plan file.	Year one and every five years thereafter and when the facilities are modified.

[1] Geo XY required for all wells. New wells must be surveyed. For existing wells, use original well installation survey data. The City of Santa Maria must also upload sample locations (e.g., influent and effluent samples) that are not defined as a **permanent monitoring well** and have not been surveyed by a licensed professional.

[2] Geo Z required for all wells. New wells must be surveyed. For existing wells, use original well installation survey data.

VII. TECHNICAL REPORTS

The technical reports are due as described in Table 11.

Table 11. Technical Report Submittal Due Dates

Report	Report Due Date
Operations and Maintenance Manual	June 16, 2024
Climate Change Adaptation Plan	June 16, 2025
Salt and Nutrient Management Plan	Not Applicable
Time Schedule Compliance Plan	June 16, 2024
Groundwater Monitoring Plan ^[1]	October 16, 2024

[1] Required if the City of Santa Maria chooses Option 2 described in section V.A.

- Operations and Maintenance Manual** – In addition to the required components specified in Standard Provisions¹⁰ A.12 and A.28 (and any updates to the

¹⁰ See General Permit Attachment E, Standard Provisions, 2013:
https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/board_decisions/dos/wdr_standard_provisions_2013.pdf

Standard Provisions) and General Permit section VI.A.2, the Operations and Maintenance Manual must contain the following components. Each component must contain an implementation schedule and identification of adequate funding to implement the component.

- i. **Sampling and Analysis Plan** – The City of Santa Maria’s Operation and Maintenance Manual must contain a sampling and analysis plan that meets the requirements specified herein. Anyone performing sampling on behalf of the City of Santa Maria must be familiar with the sampling and analysis plan. At a minimum, the sampling and analysis plan must contain the following:
 - a. A wastewater treatment process flow schematic with the monitoring locations labeled and scaled Wastewater System maps with treatment components, discharge locations (both treated wastewater and non-potable recycled water), monitoring locations, groundwater wells, storage locations (e.g., chemical, sludge, emergency overflow ponds), and buildings. If the City of Santa Maria needs to update Figure 1 to comply with this requirement, a copy of the updated process flow schematic will also be included with the annual report.
 - b. Sample identification details in tabular format. The table must include the sample titles, GeoTracker field point information, sample description(s), and sampling frequencies.
 - c. Sample chain-of-custody procedures and documentation.
 - d. Sample handling/preservation procedures.
 - e. A description of the analytical methods.
 - f. A description of sample containers, preservatives, and holding times.
 - g. For water supply monitoring, a description of the location and method of data collection (e.g., onsite well sampling, use of consumer confidence report).
 - h. For groundwater monitoring, a description of the well purging and field methods.
 - ii. **Sludge Management Plan** – The City of Santa Maria’s Operation and Maintenance Manual must contain a sludge management plan that is sufficient to ensure compliance with the terms of the General Permit and the notice of applicability. At a minimum, the plan must describe the following:
-

- a. An estimated volume/amount and quality of sludge and scum that will be generated.
 - b. How sludge, scum, and supernatant will be stored and disposed of to protect groundwater quality.
 - c. If sludge will be subject to further treatment, describe the treatment and storage requirements.
 - d. Procedures for cleaning of digesters or storage vessels and the treatment and disposal of the residuals. If drying of residuals is planned, describe how that will be performed to prevent nuisance odors, prevent vectors, and protect groundwater quality.
- iii. **Wastewater Disposal Management Plan** – The City of Santa Maria's Operation and Maintenance Manual must contain a wastewater disposal management plan that is sufficient to ensure compliance with the terms of the General Permit and the notice of applicability. At a minimum, the wastewater disposal management plan must include:
 - a. A description of the wastewater disposal area and a map denoting acreage.
 - b. Loading calculations based on flow volumes, applied acreage, and biochemical oxygen demand, salts (total dissolved solids, sodium, chloride, sulfate, boron), and nitrogen analytical results.
 - c. A description of wastewater disposal and water quality protection practices.
- iv. **Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan** – The City of Santa Maria's Operation and Maintenance Manual must contain a spill prevention and emergency response plan that is sufficient to ensure compliance with the terms of the General Permit and the notice of applicability. The spill prevention and emergency response plan must describe operation and maintenance activities to prevent accidental releases of wastewater and to effectively respond to such releases and minimize the environmental impact. At a minimum, the spill prevention and emergency response plan must address the following:
 - a. Operation and Control of Wastewater System - A description of the wastewater treatment equipment, operational controls, flow measurement and calibration procedures, and treatment system schematic including valve/gate locations.
 - b. Sludge Handling - A description of the sludge handling equipment, operational controls, and disposal procedures.
 - c. Collection System Maintenance - A description of collection system cleaning and maintenance, equipment tests, and alarm functionality tests to minimize the potential for wastewater spills originating in the

collection system or headworks. For collection systems subject to State Water Board Order WQ 2022-0103-DWQ, Statewide Waste Discharge Requirements General Order for Sanitary Sewer Systems (or its replacement), reports prepared to comply with State Water Board Order WQ 2022-0103-DWQ satisfy this requirement.

- d. **Emergency Response** - A description of emergency response procedures including for emergencies such as power outage, severe weather, flooding, or inadequate freeboard (for systems with wastewater treatment, storage, or disposal ponds or treated non-potable recycled water storage ponds). An equipment and telephone list for contractors/consultants, emergency personnel, and equipment vendors.
 - e. **Finance** - At a minimum, discuss current fees, projected fees, current budget for spill prevention and emergency response, projected budget for spill prevention and emergency response.
 - f. **Notification Procedures** - Coordination procedures with fire, police, Governor's Office of Emergency Services (CalOES), Central Coast Water Board, and local county health department personnel.
 - v. **Training Records Log** – The City of Santa Maria's Operation and Maintenance Manual must contain updated training records logs that demonstrate the City of Santa Maria is complying with General Permit section VI.B.3.
2. **Climate Change Adaptation** –The Climate Change Adaptation Plan must, at a minimum, include the following components:
- i. **Hazards and Vulnerabilities** – Identify climate change hazards, at a minimum accounting for the hazards listed below, applicable to the Wastewater System. Using up-to-date tools, data, and guidance from the State of California (e.g., Cal-Adapt¹¹, Sea-Level Rise Guidance from Ocean Protection Council, reports from the Climate-Safe Infrastructure

¹¹ Cal-Adapt is an online resource with downscaled climate project data. It provides users with projections and more detailed downloadable data supporting a range of needs and array of climate models and emissions scenarios. Cal-Adapt offers climate projections for the major stressors facing California, including the following: temperature averages and extremes, precipitation averages and extremes, sea-level rise, wildfires, and drought. The Governor's Office of Planning and Research (OPR) recommends agencies use Representative Concentration Pathway (RCP) 8.5 for analyses considering impacts through 2050, because there are minimal differences between emissions scenarios during the first half of the 21st century.

Working Group, the Climate Adaptation Planning Guide, and California Climate Assessment Regional Reports), assess the Wastewater System's vulnerability to identified hazards that could cause reduction, loss, or failure of treatment processes and/or critical structures at the Wastewater System. Identify and justify the resources (e.g., models and tools, design parameters) used to inform identification of these hazards and vulnerabilities.

- a. Sea Level Rise – Saltwater intrusion, flooding and inundation, and increased coastal erosion.
- b. Precipitation Pattern Changes.
 - I. Drought – Decreased influent quantity and quality.
 - II. Peak Events – Flooding and increased influent quantity.
- c. Temperature fluctuations and extremes.
- d. Increased wildfires.
- e. Increased power outages.
- ii. Resiliency Actions – Identify actions to build Wastewater System and operational resilience to identified vulnerabilities, accounting for options that minimize resource impacts.
- iii. Adaptation Strategy – For Wastewater Systems with design flows over 1,000,000 gallons per day, develop and implement a strategy to complete resiliency actions, at a minimum encompassing the following:
 - a. Prioritization – Prioritized resiliency actions based on risks to water quality, but also accounting for costs and benefits.
 - b. Schedule and Milestones – Timeframes to complete prioritized resiliency actions and/or climate change hazard triggers to inform when the City of Santa Maria must implement actions. Milestones to complete critical steps for prioritized resiliency actions, designed to demonstrate measurable progress at a steady, or accelerated, completion pace over the established timeframes.
 - c. Financial Planning – Projected costs necessary to implement and sustain resiliency actions and strategy to procure funds.
- iv. Recycled Water Feasibility Plan – Dischargers with Wastewater System design flows over 1,000,000 gallons per day must include a recycled water feasibility plan.

The recycled water feasibility plan will assess the viability of using the Wastewater System's treated wastewater effluent for beneficial reuse including, but not limited to the following:

- a. Beneficial Reuse Options – Identification of reuse opportunities for the City of Santa Maria's treated effluent that would achieve the highest beneficial impact and best uses possible of non-potable recycled

water. Include assessment of the following non-potable recycled water benefits identified in the State Water Board Recycled Water Policy: providing safe alternatives to fresh water or potable water for approved uses; supporting sustainable groundwater and surface water uses with the intent of substituting use of treated effluent for use of fresh water or potable water; and diversifying community water supplies and mitigating for the impacts of climate change.¹²

- b. **Viable Users** – Identification and viability evaluation of all potential users of the Wastewater System's treated effluent associated with identified beneficial reuse options. The City of Santa Maria must demonstrate it engaged potential water purveyors and customers about the viability of reusing the Wastewater System's treated effluent.
 - c. **Infrastructure Upgrades** – Assessment of infrastructure needs to produce non-potable recycled water for identified beneficial reuses and convey non-potable recycled water to beneficial reuse locations.
 - d. **Fiscal Analysis** – Cost estimates for identified reuse options, at a minimum including project development, construction, and long-term maintenance and lifecycle costs. This analysis shall also include identification and evaluation of the following: 1) funding options, including at a minimum, revenues from recycled water sales, grant and loan funding opportunities, and financing from other benefitting parties and 2) funding limitations.
 - e. **Schedule and Milestones for Next Steps** – Timeframes to assess the feasibility of identified beneficial reuse options and to identify proposed beneficial reuse options based on prioritized water recycling and reuse opportunities, feasibility assessments, and other factors identified by the City of Santa Maria.
 - f. **Identification of implementation schedule and adequate funding to implement the plan.**
3. **Salt and Nutrient Management Plan** – The City of Santa Maria is an active cooperating partner of the Santa Barbara County Integrated Regional Water Management (IRWM) Plan's regional water management group. The regional water management group prepared and submitted an assessment of the Santa Maria Valley Groundwater basin to the Central Coast Water Board. The assessment concluded that the dischargers participating in the workgroup were in balance for salts and nutrients in 2013. A salt and nutrient management plan is

¹² [Water Quality Control Policy for Recycled Water](#), State Water Board, adopted December 11, 2018, page 1.

currently not required while the City of Santa Maria participates in the Santa Barbara County IRWM regional water management group.

4. **Time Schedule Compliance Plan** - As set forth in General Permit sections V.A and VI.A.5, if the City of Santa Maria anticipates that additional time is needed to achieve compliance with the effluent limitations, the City of Santa Maria must prepare and submit for Central Coast Water Board review and approval, a time schedule compliance plan. At a minimum, the time schedule compliance plan must address the following:
 - i. Comparison of the current effluent quality to the effluent and groundwater limitations in General Permit Tables 3-6.
 - ii. Identification of the City of Santa Maria's choice for compliance for each constituent pursuant to General Permit section V.A.2 Option 1 or Option 2 (complying with an effluent limit or demonstrating compliance through a groundwater monitoring program).
 - iii. A detailed description and chronology of efforts, since issuance of the notice of applicability, to reduce wastes.
 - iv. Justification of the need for additional time to achieve the effluent limitations in General Permit Tables 3-6.
 - v. A detailed time schedule of specific actions the City of Santa Maria will take to achieve the effluent limitations.
 - vi. A demonstration that the time schedule requested is as short as possible, considering the technological, operation, and economic factors that affect the design, development, and implementation of the measures that are necessary to comply with the effluent limitation(s).
 - vii. If the requested time schedule exceeds one year, the proposed schedule shall include interim requirements and the date(s) for their achievement. The interim requirements shall include both of the following:
 - a. Effluent limitation(s) for the pollutant(s) of concern.
 - b. Actions, measurable milestones, and tangible products leading to compliance with the effluent limitation(s).

VIII. LEGAL REQUIREMENTS

The Central Coast Water Board's requirements that the City of Santa Maria submit the technical and monitoring reports described in this monitoring and reporting program are made pursuant to [section 13267 of the California Water Code](#). Failure to submit reports in accordance with schedules established by this General Permit and notice of applicability with attachments or failure to submit a report of sufficient technical quality to be acceptable to the Central Coast Water Board may subject the City of Santa Maria to enforcement action pursuant to section 13268 of the California Water Code. Pursuant to [section 13268 of the Water Code](#), a violation of a request made pursuant to section

13267 may subject the City of Santa Maria to civil liability assessment of up to \$1,000 per day in which the violation occurs.

The Central Coast Water Board needs the required information to ensure compliance with the notice of applicability and the General Permit. The City of Santa Maria is required to submit this information because it is subject to the General Permit and is responsible for the discharge.

The burden, including costs, of the reports bears a reasonable relationship to their need and the benefits to be obtained. The requirement for the reports is necessary to ensure compliance with the General Permit, notice of applicability, and monitoring and reporting program to protect water quality.

The City of Santa Maria must implement the above monitoring program on October 1, 2023. The Central Coast Water Board may rescind or modify this monitoring and reporting program at any time.

Ordered By:

Jennifer Epp
Digitally signed by Jennifer Epp
Date: 2023.06.15 16:19:04
-07'00'
Water Boards

for Matthew T. Keeling
Executive Officer

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